

ADITYA YADAV, *36*

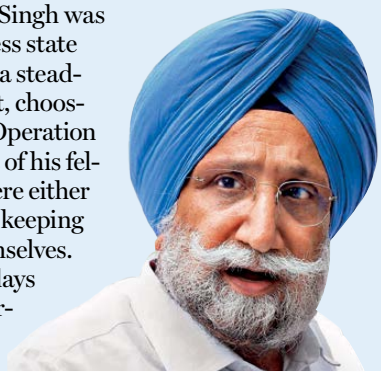
| SP | *Badaun, UP*



Things may not be exactly smooth between his father Shivpal Yadav and cousin Akhilesh, but Aditya defeated the BJP's Durvijay Shakya to reclaim the seat for SP. An alumnus of La Martinière College, Lucknow, a BBA graduate from the University of Lucknow, and with a master's in Tourism Administration, Aditya is married to Rajlakshmi, who is from the Maihar royal family. He may not have held a political post before, but helping his father in political campaigns are rubbed off.

SUKHJINDER RANDHAWA, *65*

| CONGRESS | *Gurdaspur, Punjab*



Father Santokh Singh was chief of Congress state unit twice and a steadfast Congress loyalist, choosing even to support Operation Blue Star when most of his fellow Congressmen were either quitting the party or keeping their opinion to themselves. Son Sukhjinder displays the same fearless spir-



SOUMENDU ADHIKARI, *41*

| BJP |

Kanthi, West Bengal

His father is the former MP and MLA Sisir Adhikari, his brother Suvendu Adhikari the current Nandigram MLA and leader of the Opposition. The family's loyalties shift en masse. They began as Congressmen before switching allegiance to the TMC. Then, when Suvendu defected to the BJP in December 2020, his brothers followed suit. Having held Kanthi from 2009 to 2024, the 82-year-old Sisir decided to pass the baton to his youngest son.



SUDHAKAR SINGH, *48*

| RJD | *Buxar, Bihar*

Son of RJD state president and Lalu confidant Jagadanand Singh, Sudhakar had scored a political and moral victory when he resigned as agriculture minister in the Nitish government in Oct. 2022. The corruption in that department, the then Ramgarh MLA had said, made him feel like a "*choron ka sardar*" (king of crooks). This election, he added another feather to his cap as he defeated Mithilesh Tiwari to wrest Buxar, christened 'mini Kashi' given its proximity to PM Modi's seat Varanasi, and which had remained a saffron stronghold since 1996 barring 2009 when Jagadanand won.



VARUN CHAUDHRY, *44*

| CONGRESS |

Ambala (SC), Haryana

Son of four-time MLA and former minister Phool Chand Mullana, Varun was handpicked by Bhupinder Singh Hooda to challenge the BJP's Banto Kataria, widow of former Union minister Rattan Lal Kataria. Hooda managed to get Kumari Selja shifted from this seat, and bet on the Mullana family's influence among rural folk to win the seat. A lawyer by profession, Varun had won the Mullana seat in the 2019 assembly poll, a role that won him the Best Legislator award. He has shown his mettle again, and done Hooda proud.



UJJWAL RAMAN SINGH, *51*

| CONGRESS |

Allahabad, UP

Son of senior SP leader Revati Raman Singh, Ujjwal too started in Mulayam's party, even serving as the state environment minister in his government, launching CNG in Agra, Lucknow and Kanpur and acting as chairman of the 'Beej Vikas Nigam'. However, a month and a half before the election, Ujjwal joined the Congress, winning the seat 40 years after Amitabh Bachchan defeated Hemwati Nandan Bahuguna here in 1984. All hail the new Prayag Raja!